

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

for Selection of Professional Service Providers

(CA Services, CS Services, Legal Services, Accounting Services)

for

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH) – Amaravati Foundation (Hub)

and

5 RTIH Spoke Foundations (Visakhapatnam, Rajahmundry, Vijayawada,
Tirupati, Anantapur)

Issued by: Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH)

RFP Reference No.: RTIH-AMVT/RFP/2025/001

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1. Background

(a) Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH), established by the Government of Andhra Pradesh through the Andhra Pradesh Innovation Society (APIS), is designed to catalyse entrepreneurship, start-ups, and the growth of micro and small enterprises (MSMEs) across the state. It supports innovators and enterprises in scaling impactful solutions, with a focus on inclusive growth in key sectors such as education, health, agritech, digital services, and livelihoods.

(b) RTIH operates through a Hub-and-Spoke network comprising six independent Section 8 companies: one central Hub entity (Amaravati Foundation) and five regional Spoke foundations located in Visakhapatnam, Rajahmundry, Vijayawada, Tirupati, and Anantapur.

(c) To ensure uniform governance, statutory compliance, financial oversight, legal vetting, and documentation standards across this network, RTIH invites proposals from qualified and experienced professional service providers.

(d) This RFP covers four Lots:

(i) Lot 1: Chartered Accountant (CA) Services

(ii) Lot 2: Company Secretary (CS) / Secretarial Compliance Services

(iii) Lot 3: Legal Advisory Services

(iv) Lot 4: Accounting & Bookkeeping Services

(e) Bidders may apply for one or more Lots. Evaluation will be conducted Lot-wise, and contracts may be awarded separately for each Lot.

(f) Bidders demonstrating the capability to deliver across multiple Lots will receive additional marks under the “Cross-Functional Capability” evaluation criterion.

2. Key Dates and Timeline

The following table outlines the indicative schedule for this RFP process. RTIH reserves the right to modify these dates at its discretion, with due notice to participating Bidders:

Milestone	Date
Release of RFP	24 Nov 2025
Last date to submit queries	27 Nov 2025
Response to queries / issuance of corrigendum	28 Nov 2025
Last date for submission of proposals	05 Dec 2025 (by 5:00 PM IST)
Opening of technical proposals	06 Dec 2025
Evaluation of technical proposals	06-10 Dec 2025
Opening of financial proposals	11 Dec 2025
Announcement of selected Bidders (per Lot)	12 Dec 2025
Contract signing and commencement	15 Dec 2025

(Note: All communication and clarifications shall be routed through the designated contact point mentioned in this RFP. RTIH may extend the proposal submission deadline at its discretion and will share updates via email or publish them on its website, if applicable.)

3. Scope of Work

The Scope of Work outlined below shall be applicable and deliverable across all RTIH entities, including the Hub and five Spoke Foundations.

LOT 1: CHARTERED ACCOUNTANT (CA) SERVICES

(a) **Monthly**

- (i) Independent review of books of accounts and ledgers
- (ii) Verification of reconciliations across bank accounts, advances, and inter-entity balances
- (iii) Review of outstanding advances, asset utilisation, and liability balances
- (iv) Provision of advisory support on indirect and direct tax matters, including GST and TDS, as applicable

(b) **Quarterly**

- (i) Preparation and submission of quarterly financial statements
- (ii) MIS consolidation for Group CEO
- (iii) Financial compliance review, including internal control observations and checklists on statutory deadlines, inter-entity transactions, reconciliations, and tax liabilities

(c) **Annual**

- (i) Assistance in preparation for statutory audits, including draft schedules and documentation
- (ii) Drafting of entity-wise financial statements and related notes/schedules as per applicable norms
- (iii) Support in the preparation and review of fund Utilisation Certificates for grants/funding bodies, where required

- (iv) Support in financial documentation and audit coordination for donor-funded or CSR-linked reviews

LOT 2: COMPANY SECRETARY (CS) / SECRETARIAL COMPLIANCE SERVICES

(a) Monthly

- (i) Maintenance and update of secretarial compliance calendar
- (ii) Upkeep of statutory registers, including directors, members, and other mandated registers

(b) Event-based

- (i) Filing of DIR-12, PAS-3, MGT-14, and other statutory forms as per applicable events and timelines
- (ii) Execution of compliance actions arising from board/shareholder resolutions under Section 8 provisions
- (iii) Preparation and filing of CSR-related returns and reports, if applicable

(c) Quarterly

- (i) Drafting and issuance of notices, agendas, and board packs for Board and Committee meetings
- (ii) Drafting and finalisation of minutes in compliance with statutory timelines
- (iii) Maintenance of a tracker for board and committee resolutions and their implementation status
- (iv) Maintaining register of Related Party Transactions and Conflict of Interest declarations, if applicable

(d) Annual

- (i) Filing of annual returns including AOC-4 and MGT-7A

- (ii) Facilitation of Annual General Meeting (AGM) documentation and process support
- (iii) Monitoring of expiry and timely renewal of Digital Signature Certificates (DSCs) for authorised signatories, and annual filing of DIR-3 KYC for directors, as per regulatory timelines
- (iv) Support in secretarial audit, including data collation and register reconciliation, if applicable
- (v) Review and updates to governance and secretarial compliance documentation

LOT 3: LEGAL ADVISORY SERVICES

- (a) Vetting of legal documents including MoUs, NDAs, grant agreements and other contracts.
- (b) Vetting of internal policies including HR, Finance, Branding, Delegation of Authority, Intellectual Property, Cybersecurity, and related protocols
- (c) Labour law advisory including employment contracts, CLRA, EPF, ESI, maternity and POSH compliance
- (d) Legal opinions and advisory on Companies Act, 2013 and Section 8 Company compliance, including director responsibilities, charitable objects, and governance matters
- (e) Non-litigation advisory for general legal issues, including notices, vendor/client disputes, indemnities, and liabilities
- (f) Risk & compliance advisory including regulatory health check-ups, compliance audits, risk registers, and exposure reporting
- (g) Data protection and IT law compliance advisory, including implications of IT Act, Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) regulations, and use of third-party platforms

- (h) Intellectual Property advisory on ownership, licensing, assignment agreements, and innovation-related protections
- (i) Legal due diligence support for funding, partnerships, collaborations, and CSR engagements
- (j) Maintenance of a central legal advisory log/tracker, summarising queries, status, and actions for all six entities

(Note: Litigation, representation before courts, or quasi-judicial authorities is excluded)

LOT 4: ACCOUNTING & BOOKKEEPING SERVICES

(a) Monthly

- (i) Maintenance of books of accounts using Tally or equivalent cloud-based systems
- (ii) Ledger maintenance
- (iii) Bank reconciliation
- (iv) Payroll processing, including statutory deductions and summary reports
- (v) Verification and recording of vendor invoices and operational expenses
- (vi) Petty cash accounting
- (vii) Preparation of MIS reports
- (viii) Accounts receivable and payable tracking, with ageing analysis
- (ix) Grant/fund-wise accounting and expense tracking for donor/CSR reporting
- (x) Maintenance of closing checklist with key control sign-offs

- (xi) Preparation of TDS ledger summary to support tax compliance submissions
- (b) **Annual**
 - (i) Finalization of accounts including ledger closure and adjustment entries
 - (ii) Preparation of audit schedules and supporting documentation for statutory and donor audits
 - (iii) Computation and posting of depreciation schedules
 - (iv) Preparation and reconciliation of the fixed asset register
 - (v) Preparation of annual balance sheet schedules (e.g., advances, deposits, provisions, liabilities)
 - (vi) Review and update of authorised signatory mandates, bank operations matrix, and cheque register
- (c) **Capacity Building & Training of Program Associates.** To strengthen internal capability across RTIH entities and enable gradual internalisation of routine accounting activities over time, the selected Service Provider for Lot 4 shall conduct a structured **Training & Handholding Programme** for Program Associates and designated RTIH staff. This shall include:
 - (i) Monthly training sessions (1–2 hours) covering:
 - (aa) Basic accounting & bookkeeping concepts
 - (ab) Use of Tally or cloud-based accounting systems
 - (ac) Vendor invoice verification & documentation standards
 - (ad) Expense classification and ledger logic
 - (ae) Bank reconciliation methodology
 - (af) Month-end closing checklist

- (ag) MIS basics (format, preparation, interpretation)
- (ii) On-the-job handholding during:
 - (aa) Month-end closure activities
 - (ab) Reconciliations
 - (ac) Ledger preparation
 - (ad) Audit documentation collation
- (iii) Preparation and sharing of standardised templates & SOPs for:
 - (aa) Invoice processing
 - (ab) Petty cash and expense documentation
 - (ac) Reconciliation formats
 - (ad) MIS formats
 - (ae) Filing and record-keeping requirements
- (iv) Quarterly skills assessment report for all Program Associates including:
 - (aa) Progress summary
 - (ab) Identified gaps
 - (ac) Recommended internalisation roadmap (tasks that can gradually be shifted internally)
- (d) **Important.** This training and handholding requirement **shall not dilute** the vendor's responsibility for accuracy, completeness, statutory compliance, or timely delivery of all accounting and bookkeeping services under Lot 4.

4. Minimum Team Requirements

The Bidder shall be responsible for deploying dedicated and qualified personnel for each Lot, in accordance with the minimum team requirements specified. In cases where the Bidder is applying for multiple Lots, a Lot-wise deployment plan must be provided, clearly demonstrating adequate and non-overlapping staffing capacity across all proposed Lots. All personnel proposed for the assignment must either be full-time employees of the Bidder or engaged through valid professional contracts for the entire duration of the engagement. The minimum team deployment requirements per Lot are as follows:

(a) **Lot 1 Chartered Accountant (CA) Services**

- (i) One (1) Qualified Chartered Accountant (Lead)
- (ii) One (1) Semi-qualified Chartered Accountant

(b) **Lot 2 Company Secretary (CS) / Secretarial Compliance Services**

- (i) One (1) Qualified Company Secretary
- (ii) One (1) Semi-Qualified Company Secretary

(c) **Lot 3 (Legal)**

- (i) One (1) Legal Professional with minimum five (5) years of post-qualification experience
- (ii) One (1) Junior Legal Associate

(d) **Lot 4 (Accounting)**

- (i) One (1) Senior Accountant (with 5+ years' experience)
- (ii) One (1) Junior Accountant

5. Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for consideration, the Bidder must meet the following minimum criteria:

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- (a) Be a registered professional firm (Chartered Accountant, Company Secretary, Legal, or related services) with valid licenses/registrations applicable to the service category being bid for
- (b) Have a minimum of three (3) years of operational experience in delivering similar professional services
- (c) Employ at least ten (10) full-time staff across relevant functional areas
- (d) Demonstrate prior experience in working with Section 8 Companies, NGOs, CSR-funded entities, or similar multi-entity structures
- (e) Have a functional office presence in Andhra Pradesh or Telangana
- (f) Must not be blacklisted or debarred by any government, quasi-government, donor, or public sector agency in India
- (g) In exceptional circumstances, RTIH may consider individual practitioners—such as Chartered Accountants, Company Secretaries, or Legal Professionals—who are duly registered with their respective statutory bodies (e.g., ICAI, ICSI, Bar Council of India) and have a minimum of three (3) years of experience. Such practitioners must: (i) Demonstrate prior experience with Section 8 companies, NGOs, or startup incubators; (ii) Submit at least two (2) endorsements attesting to their performance and relevance; and (iii) Provide a clear, merit-based justification in their Technical Proposal aligning their capabilities with the Scope of Work. Acceptance of such proposals shall be solely at the discretion of RTIH, based on merit, scope alignment, and suitability for the specific Lots applied for.

6. Evaluation Framework

- (a) The selection shall be based on the **Quality and Cost-Based Selection (QCBS)** methodology, with a total of **100 marks**, distributed as follows:
 - (i) Technical Score: 40 Marks
 - (ii) Financial Score: 60 Marks

6.1 Technical Evaluation (40 Marks)

S No	Criteria	Marks
(a)	Experience with Section 8 / NGOs / multi-entity	10
(b)	Staff Strength	10
(c)	Approach & Methodology	10
(d)	Relevant Clients	5
(e)	Cross-Functional Capability: Based on number of Lots applied for	5
	Total	40/ 40

Note 1: For **Lot 4 (Accounting & Bookkeeping Services)**, an additional criterion for “Training & Capacity Building Capability” (5 marks) is applicable. To maintain consistency across all Lots, the maximum obtainable technical score remains 40 marks—the raw score for Lot 4 will be adjusted using the formula:

$$\text{Technical Score (Lot 4)} = (\text{Marks Obtained} / 45) \times 40$$

Note 2: For **Cross-Functional Capability**, a maximum of 5 marks shall be awarded based on the number of Lots applied for by a Bidder, as follows:

- (i) Bid for 2 Lots → 2 marks
- (ii) Bid for 3 Lots → 4 marks
- (iii) Bid for 4 Lots → 5 marks

6.2 Financial Evaluation (60 Marks)

(a) Evaluation shall be conducted **Lot-wise**, based on the financial quote submitted per Lot

(b) The Financial Score (FS) shall be computed using the following formula:

$$FS = (L1 \text{ Price for that Lot} / \text{Bidder's Price for that Lot}) \times 60$$

6.3 Composite Score (Per Lot)

- (a) Composite = Technical Score (out of 40) + Financial Score (out of 60)
- (b) The Bidder with the **highest Composite Score** in each Lot shall be declared the **successful Bidder for that Lot**.

Submission Requirements

(a) Documents to be Submitted

Bidders must submit the following documents as part of their proposal, compiled into clearly labelled and signed PDFs:

- (i) Technical Proposal (including approach & methodology)
- (ii) Financial Proposal (as per Annexure A)
- (iii) CVs of proposed team members (per Lot)
- (iv) Firm registration documents
- (v) PAN and GST copies
- (vi) List of relevant clients / engagements
- (vii) Declarations (as per Annexure B)

(b) Submission Method:

Proposals must be submitted through either of the following channels:

Email: proposals@rtih.co.in

or

RTIH Form Link: <https://forms.gle/6EWB9wUiybFwpVpD6>

(Note: File names should clearly identify the Bidder and the Lot(s) applied for. Submissions must be complete, virus-free, and within permissible file size limits. Incomplete or corrupt files may lead to disqualification.)

(c) Point of Contact:

For any clarifications, please contact:

Name: Lt Cdr Nikhil AG (retd.)

Designation: Strategic Initiatives & Impact Lead

Email: proposals@rtih.ap.gov.in

8. General Provisions

(a) **Proposal Validity.** All submitted proposals shall remain valid and binding for a period of 90 days from the submission deadline. Any proposal with a shorter validity period shall be considered non-compliant.

(b) **Right to Accept or Reject Proposals.** RTIH reserves the right to accept or reject any proposal, to annul the bidding process, or to award Lots individually or in combination, without assigning any reason and without incurring any liability to any bidder. Proposals that are incomplete, submitted after the deadline, or found to contain material deviations from the RFP requirements may be declared non-responsive and rejected without further evaluation.

(c) **Contract Period.** Contracts shall be executed only with the selected Bidder(s) post-evaluation, and such contracts shall detail all applicable terms, obligations, deliverables, and compliance requirements. The initial contract period shall be two (2) years from the date of commencement, extendable by one (1) additional year based on satisfactory performance and mutual agreement.

(d) **Performance & Penalties.** The selected Service Provider(s) shall be accountable for delivering services in a timely and accurate manner, as per the scope defined in this RFP. Non-adherence to statutory deadlines, documentation standards, or other key deliverables may attract penalties, including: (i) **Up to 2%** of the applicable Lot's monthly fee for delays in statutory filings (e.g., MCA - RoC); (ii) **Up to 1%** of the applicable Lot's monthly fee, per instance, for delays in Board minutes or compliance documentation. Repeated non-compliance may result in warnings, payment withholdings, or termination of engagement. RTIH reserves the right to periodically review performance and take appropriate corrective measures.

- (e) **Confidentiality.** Bidders shall treat all information shared under this RFP as confidential. No part of the RFP or subsequent clarifications may be disclosed to any third party without prior written permission from RTIH.
- (f) **Conflict of Interest.** Bidders must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest, including personal or professional relationships with RTIH officials, staff, or consultants. Proposals found to have undisclosed conflicts may be disqualified. The Service Provider appointed under this RFP shall not be eligible for appointment as the Statutory Auditor for any RTIH entity, in order to maintain independence and avoid any conflict of interest under applicable ICAI guidelines.
- (g) **Compliance with Legal and Professional Standards.** While Bidders may apply for multiple Lots, it is their sole responsibility to ensure such participation is in full compliance with all applicable laws, regulations, and professional codes of conduct prescribed by statutory bodies such as ICAI, ICSI, and the Bar Council of India. RTIH does not encourage proposals that may lead to regulatory or ethical conflicts, or involve disqualifications or restrictions under applicable frameworks. Any proposal found to be non-compliant with such legal or professional norms shall be liable for disqualification at the sole discretion of RTIH.
- (h) **Misrepresentation / Fraudulent Practices.** If a Bidder is found to have misrepresented facts, submitted fraudulent documents, or engaged in any corrupt or unfair practices, RTIH reserves the right to disqualify the bidder or terminate the engagement without liability. Any proposal which includes terms or conditions that materially deviate from the requirements of this RFP—including scope, eligibility, team composition, or evaluation criteria—may be disqualified without further consideration.
- (i) **Blacklisting / Debarment.** Bidders must certify that they have not been blacklisted or debarred by any government agency, funding body, or donor organisation. Any false declaration will result in immediate rejection or cancellation of award.

- (j) **Subcontracting.** The selected Service Provider shall not subcontract any part of the services without prior written approval from RTIH.
- (k) **Proposal Costs.** All costs incurred by the Bidder in preparation and submission of its proposal shall be borne by the Bidder. RTIH shall not be liable for any expense incurred by any Bidder in connection with this RFP or any subsequent contract, regardless of the outcome of the bidding process.
- (l) **Non-Binding.** This RFP does not constitute an offer or a legally binding obligation on the part of RTIH. Receipt of proposals in response to this RFP shall not oblige RTIH to award any contract or engage any Bidder. RTIH reserves the right to cancel, modify or re-issue the RFP at its discretion without assigning any reason.
- (m) **Dispute Resolution.** Any disputes arising during the RFP process shall be resolved through mutual discussion. RTIH's decision in this regard shall be final and binding.

ANNEXURE A – FINANCIAL BID FORMAT

(To be submitted Lot-wise as a separate PDF)

Bidder Name: _____

RFP Reference No.: _____

Date of Submission: _____

Entity	Lot 1 (CA)	Lot 2 (CS)	Lot 3 (Legal)	Lot 4 (Accounting)	Total
RTIH Amaravati	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Vizag	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Rajahmundry	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Vijayawada	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Tirupati	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Anantapur	₹	₹	₹	₹	₹
Grand Total					

Per-Lot Total (if applicable): _____

Discount Offered for Multiple Lots (if any):

Consolidated Engagement Rate (if applicable):

Authorised Signatory: _____

Name: _____

Designation: _____

Date: _____

(Seal, if applicable)

Additional Notes

- (a) All prices quoted must be exclusive of GST and other applicable taxes, which shall be payable as per prevailing laws.
- (b) The quoted prices shall remain firm and unchanged during the entire contract period, including the extension period if exercised.
- (c) Bidders applying for multiple Lots must ensure that the Lot-wise price break-up is clearly provided and should be independently evaluable.
- (d) Any applicable per-Lot total, discounts for multiple Lot awards, or consolidated pricing proposals should be explicitly stated.

ANNEXURE B – DECLARATIONS

(To be printed on the official letterhead of the Bidder and signed by an authorised signatory)

Date: _____

To

The Chief Executive Officer

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH) – Amaravati Foundation

Mayuri Tech Park, 4th Floor,

Mangalagiri, Andhra Pradesh – 522503

Subject: Declarations for RFP – Professional Service Providers (CA / CS / Legal / Accounting Services)

Dear Sir/Madam,

In connection with our proposal submitted under the above-referenced RFP, we hereby make the following declarations on behalf of **[Name of the Bidder]**:

1. Eligibility Declaration

We confirm that our firm is a duly registered and eligible professional entity as required under the RFP. We hold all necessary approvals, registrations, and authorisations to render the services for which we are submitting our proposal.

2. Declaration of Non-Blacklisting

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We hereby declare that our firm, including all partners/directors, has not been blacklisted, debarred, suspended, or declared ineligible by any Government department, PSU, statutory authority, donor organisation, multilateral agency, or regulatory body in India or abroad, as on the date of submission.

3. Declaration of Conflict of Interest

We confirm that:

(a) We do not have any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest with RTIH, its Hub or Spoke Foundations, their officials, employees, Board members, or consultants; and

(b) If any conflict arises at any stage during evaluation or during the contract period, we shall immediately disclose the same in writing to RTIH.

Neither our firm nor any of our personnel have any direct or indirect relationship that may impair our independence or objectivity in delivering the proposed services. We further confirm that our participation does not contravene any statutory, regulatory, or professional guidelines issued by ICAI, ICSI, the Bar Council of India, or any other competent authority.

4. Declaration of Litigation / Regulatory Proceedings

We disclose below any litigation, regulatory actions, disciplinary proceedings, or investigations currently involving our firm or key personnel, which may reasonably be relevant to this engagement:

Case Title / Authority:



Nature of Matter:

Current Status:

(Write "None" if no such matters exist.)

We further confirm that we are not involved in any major litigation that may materially affect our capacity to perform the services proposed.

5. Declaration of Authenticity

We hereby declare that all information, statements, documents, and certifications submitted as part of our Technical and Financial Proposals are true, correct, and complete. We understand that any misrepresentation, falsification, or concealment of facts may lead to immediate rejection of our proposal or termination of any contract awarded, without liability on RTIH.

6. Acceptance of RFP Terms

We have fully read and understood the RFP, including all conditions, requirements, timelines, and evaluation criteria, and we hereby agree to comply with the RFP in full without deviations.

For and on behalf of:

[Name of the Bidder]

Authorised Signatory: -----

Name: -----

Designation: -----

Date: -----

(Seal, if applicable)

